Syed Huzaifa Bin Afzal

CLOUD INFRASTRUCTURE / DEVOPS ENGINEER

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EDUCATION

Master of Cybersecurity & Leadership University of Washington Tacoma — June 2025 - June 2026
GPA 3.99/4.00. Honor society recognition: Beta Gamma Sigma (business) and Upsilon Pi Epsilon (computing).

B.S. Computer Science Ghulam Ishaq Khan Institute — August 2015 - June 2019
First place, Computer Science final-year project, for LifeTrack.

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cloud infrastructure and DevOps engineer with nearly six years of AWS experience across production SaaS and enterprise client workloads. Built reusable Terraform modules and self-service infrastructure, refactored Jenkins delivery workflows, automated cloud operations with Python and AWS Systems Manager, and improved disaster recovery and cost visibility. AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate and first author of IEEE-published work on secure, self-hosted generative AI.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Harri — March 2022 - May 2025
DevOps Engineer (Contract) · Remote
Contracted through Kalam4Solutions

- Built and maintained seven reusable Terraform modules covering services such as API Gateway v2, CloudFront, Route 53, OpenSearch, and Redshift. The reusable patterns reduced manual provisioning effort by approximately 40%.
- Created Terraform modules for Aurora/RDS, Redis, S3, DynamoDB, API Gateway v2, and VPC networking to automate provisioning across three AWS accounts and four environments. Refactored Terraform and reviewed infrastructure designs to standardize deployments.
- Refactored Jenkins deployment workflows, removed unreliable deployment steps, and standardized release practices. Reviewed Terraform and pipeline changes using Git and Bitbucket and used Python and shell scripting for infrastructure automation.
- Operated production EKS and ECS workloads and supported dependencies across VPC networking, IAM, Aurora/RDS, Redis/ElastiCache, OpenSearch, DynamoDB, S3, and Lambda across three AWS accounts and four environments.
- Investigated application, container, networking, and datastore failures with CloudWatch, Datadog, application logs, and service telemetry. Worked with development teams on incident response, root-cause follow-up, and post-change validation.
- Contributed to approximately 30% lower annual AWS spend through rightsizing, AWS Trusted Advisor and Compute Optimizer analysis, capacity planning, Reserved Instance strategy, and architecture improvements.
- Implemented OpenSearch cross-cluster replication and contributed to Aurora Global Database planning and multi-region recovery procedures. Ran disaster recovery drills with engineering teams and documented recovery checks and runbooks.
- Refined IAM, RBAC, SSO, and least-privilege access patterns. Used AWS Systems Manager to centralize audited session access and reduce reliance on static SSH keys.
- Mentored engineers and interns and contributed to infrastructure design reviews, code reviews, and incident handoffs. Recognized as a Harri Top Performer in 2023 and 2024.

Systems Limited — July 2019 - March 2022
Cloud Infrastructure / Software Engineer · Lahore, Pakistan
Assigned to U.S. subsidiary Visionet Systems Inc.

- Built self-service Jenkins/CloudBees pipelines and a reusable Terraform module for AWS EMR provisioning and teardown for Regeneron, with approvals, S3-backed Terraform state, and requester ownership checks before teardown.
- Worked on a migration of an EC2-hosted application to Docker and ECS Fargate, with an Application Load Balancer, private Route 53 DNS for service discovery, and Terraform-defined deployment and networking.
- Developed AWS Systems Manager documents to automate Linux and Windows patching, and built a Python/Boto3 AWS Lambda workflow for EC2 scheduler exceptions requested through ServiceNow.
- Tracked P1/P2 incidents in ServiceNow, maintained runbooks and escalation notes, and operated Jenkins CI/CD workflows with release gates and rollback procedures.

PROJECTS

Contributed to the Terraform AWS RDS Aurora module (merged PR #307)
Added optional Aurora cluster and instance parameter groups and a configurable autoscaling policy name.

Contributed to the Terraform AWS DynamoDB Table module (merged PR #59)
Added DynamoDB replica tag propagation.

GovernAI, UW Tacoma graduate research (first author, IEEE SVCC 2026)
Self-hosted enterprise generative AI platform using Docker, Ollama, Open WebUI, and a quantized Qwen model, with role-based access and local inference.

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate — Issued October 2023, expires October 2027
Building Generative AI Applications Using Amazon Bedrock (course) — October 2026

SKILLS

AWS and networking: EC2, VPC, subnets, routing, security groups, ALB/ELB, Route 53, CloudFront, API Gateway, IAM
Containers and delivery: EKS, Kubernetes, ECS/Fargate, ECR, Docker, Terraform, CloudFormation, Jenkins/CloudBees, GitLab CI/CD
Data and reliability: RDS/Aurora, DynamoDB, OpenSearch, ElastiCache/Redis, S3, CloudWatch, Datadog, multi-region disaster recovery, runbooks
Automation and security: Python/Boto3, Bash, PowerShell, Lambda, AWS Systems Manager, Linux, Windows Server, IAM/RBAC/SSO, least privilege